madlen

CANDIDATE CASE STUDY

GROWTH INTERN CASE STUDY

A defensible growth story, made tangible.

Competitive analysis · Unique value proposition · 30-Day Classroom Proof Pilot · AI mini-product prototype · PYP Unit Planner social campaign

LIVE PROTOTYPE	SOURCE
Open public application	View GitHub repository

24 AUGUST 2026

Executive recommendation

Madlen should not compete by claiming the longest list of AI tools. MagicSchool already owns breadth, while Brisk owns the promise of working inside tools teachers already use. Madlen's more defensible position is a coherent, curriculum-aware learning journey: one learning outcome connects planning, student activity, assessment, and the teacher's next action.

The recommended growth initiative is the Madlen 30-Day Classroom Proof Pilot, supported by the campaign line One Outcome. One Learning Loop. Instead of asking a school to trust another AI demo, the pilot lets it test one real learning objective across planning, student activity, and feedback, then make a purchasing decision using evidence from its own teachers and curriculum.

1. Competitive analysis

Why these two competitors

I selected MagicSchool and Brisk Teaching because both challenge Madlen at platform level rather than through one isolated generator. MagicSchool represents the broad K-12 AI suite; Brisk represents the embedded workflow layer. Together they test whether Madlen's proposed value is genuinely differentiated against both breadth and convenience.

Competitor 1: MagicSchool

MagicSchool's principal strength is breadth wrapped in an education-first brand. Its public plans advertise more than 80 teacher tools, more than 50 student tools, a forever-free individual tier, Plus at $8.33 per user/month when billed annually or $12.99 monthly, and custom-priced Enterprise plans with curriculum alignment, administrative controls, SSO, LMS/SIS integrations, safeguards, dashboards, professional development, and support. The UX reduces prompt-writing anxiety through named tools, examples, and templates, while the brand consistently emphasizes teacher time, safety, and human connection. Its scale is a meaningful reputation signal: an Anthropic customer story reports three million teachers, and its integrations and district-facing controls make it credible with institutional buyers.

Its strength also creates Madlen's opening. A catalogue of 80+ teacher tools can communicate capability, but it can make the product story depend on tool discovery and volume. Curriculum alignment is strongest in Enterprise and can be configured using district context; on the public pages reviewed, MagicSchool does not foreground a ready-made, named PYP workflow comparable to Madlen's bilingual PYP Unit Planner. This is not evidence that MagicSchool cannot support IB. It means Madlen should avoid an exclusivity claim and instead demonstrate lower setup effort, visible framework structure, and output fidelity. A second weakness shared by all generative platforms is that polished output can still require factual and pedagogical review; MagicSchool itself recommends educator review rather than automatic classroom use.

Competitor 2: Brisk Teaching

Brisk's strongest advantage is low-friction UX: it works inside Google and Microsoft workflows where teachers already read, write, give feedback, and build resources. Its connected offer now includes the Brisk Extension, student-facing Brisk Boost, and the planning hub Brisk Next. The brand promise is simple and memorable - AI where teachers already work - and the free plan includes 20+ tools. School and district plans add standards alignment, curriculum setup, cross-classroom insight, governance, and support at custom pricing; the current public Educator Pro page describes unlimited use and upgraded models but does not display a price. Market traction is substantial: Brisk states that more than two million teachers and more than 20,000 districts use it, and Tech & Learning named it a 2025 Best for Back to School winner.

The competitive opening is not that Brisk lacks curriculum capability. Its Premium and Intelligence plans can be grounded in district standards, rubrics, pacing, scope, sequence, and adopted materials. The trade-off is that its differentiation is tied to embedding and school-configured context, with the richest curriculum fidelity and analytics positioned in institution-level plans. The public pages reviewed do not foreground a named, first-party PYP planning template. Madlen can therefore compete by making a framework-specific workflow immediately visible and by showing the learning outcome continuing from plan to student evidence and feedback in one native story. Brisk's scale, multilingual capabilities, and evidence study also mean Madlen cannot win with “we are local” or “we translate” alone.

What Madlen should and should not claim

Claim	Recommendation	Reason
“Only Madlen supports IB.”	Do not use.	Competitors can be configured with school curriculum, and absence from a public product page is not proof of technical inability.
“Madlen connects the whole learning lifecycle.”	Lead with it, then demonstrate it.	It turns a broad toolset into one understandable teacher outcome: prepare, guide, assess, act.
“Ready-made framework workflows reduce setup.”	Prove with PYP output and time-to-first-plan.	Madlen publicly shows a bilingual, editable PYP flow built from a transdisciplinary theme and central idea.
“AI saves teachers time.”	Use only with measured pilot evidence.	Every competitor makes a time-saving claim; an unsupported number will not differentiate Madlen.

2. Unique value proposition - maximum two sentences

Madlen turns one learning objective into a curriculum-aligned lesson, guided student practice, and teacher-reviewed feedback in one connected workflow. Teachers save time, schools reduce fragmented AI use, and every output remains editable and under educator control.

Why this wording

- Problem made explicit: teachers often move between disconnected AI tools, while school leaders cannot see whether those tools create a consistent learning process.
- Outcome before technology: the statement explains the teacher and school benefit without requiring the reader to understand models, prompts, or analytics architecture.
- Defensible difference: the same learning objective continues through planning, student support, and teacher-reviewed feedback; curriculum fit and teacher control keep the promise credible.
- Counterargument - competitors also connect workflows: true. Madlen must prove that the same outcome survives all three stages with little setup; the pilot below is designed to create that proof.

3. Strategic initiative: Madlen 30-Day Classroom Proof Pilot

Campaign line: One Outcome. One Learning Loop.

Initiative type: targeted go-to-market pilot campaign, not a new dashboard or an open-ended free trial.

The idea in plain language

Question	Clear answer
What problem are we solving?	School leaders see impressive AI demos but still cannot tell whether teachers will use the product consistently, whether it fits their curriculum, or whether it creates measurable value.
What is the initiative?	A school tests one real learning objective with 5-10 teachers for 30 days, from lesson preparation to student activity and teacher-reviewed feedback.
What does the school receive?	A one-page evidence report showing adoption, time saved, student participation, teacher edits, and curriculum-fit issues.
What opportunity does this create for Madlen?	It turns a generic product demo into credible purchase evidence, identifies serious buyers, and creates reusable school proof stories.

Core value: Madlen turns a product demo into evidence a school can use to make a confident purchasing decision.

Objective

Reduce the uncertainty that slows school adoption. In 30 days, each participating teacher should complete one measurable loop around a single learning outcome: prepare a lesson, run a guided student activity, review aligned evidence, and decide the next instructional step. Madlen then uses the results to qualify the school's next purchase or expansion conversation.

Target audience and selection

- Buyer/sponsor: Head of Teaching and Learning, academic coordinator, or school leader.
- Core segment: private and international-program schools in Türkiye, particularly schools using PYP/IB or another named international framework alongside local requirements.
- Pilot group: one sponsor, one coordinator, and 5-10 teachers from a coherent grade or department.
- Qualification rule: the school must nominate an owner, select an outcome before launch, and attend the final evidence review. This prevents a free pilot from filling with uncommitted tool explorers.

The campaign mechanism

1. Recruit: targeted LinkedIn/email outreach and a concise landing page invite academic leaders to prove one learning outcome, not “try 80 AI tools.”
2. Baseline: record the existing preparation, activity, and feedback workflow; expected time; curriculum/framework; and the evidence the school normally sees.
3. 20-minute launch: the teacher chooses one outcome, grade, and framework and creates the first plan with a Madlen facilitator.
4. Run the loop: Week 1 lesson/material; Weeks 2-3 guided student activity; Week 4 assessment/feedback and next-step review.
5. Return proof: Madlen provides a one-page school impact summary showing completion, time comparison, student participation, teacher edits, alignment corrections, and recommended next action.
6. Convert responsibly: the final meeting offers an expanded pilot or proposal only if the predefined usefulness and quality thresholds are met.

Required campaign assets

- One focused landing page and application form.
- Academic-leader outreach copy and the PYP Unit Planner social creative.
- A facilitator checklist and three short email nudges tied to the three loop stages.
- Baseline and exit surveys with identical time/usefulness questions.
- A reusable one-page impact-report template.

These assets are deliberately lighter than building a new analytics product. The first question is whether the integrated promise activates and converts a school; only then is deeper product instrumentation justified.

Success metrics and decision rules

Targets below are pilot hypotheses, not forecasts. They create a decision standard before results are known.

Three primary growth signals

Metric	Exact definition	Initial target	Decision it informs
Teacher activation	Invited teachers completing a plan plus student activity within 7 days	>=70%	Is setup understandable and fast?
Full-loop completion	Activated teachers completing all three stages within 30 days	>=50%	Is the lifecycle real rather than a feature-list story?
Pilot-to-next-step	Schools requesting proposal or expanded pilot / completed pilots	>=30%	Does product evidence create a growth outcome?

Supporting quality and learning checks

Metric	Exact definition	Initial target	Decision it informs
Qualified pilot rate	Sponsor-approved pilots / qualified school conversations	>=25%	Is the proposition compelling to buyers?
Median time saved	Baseline estimate minus reported actual time for the same loop	>=90 min	Is value meaningful enough to continue testing?
Student activity completion	Students completing the assigned activity / students assigned	>=65%	Does value reach students, not only planning?
Teacher usefulness	Teachers rating the completed loop 8-10 on a 10-point scale	>=60%	Is there an early retention signal?
Serious alignment correction rate	Outputs needing a material curriculum/level correction / reviewed outputs	<=15%	Is framework fidelity credible?

Likely objections and responses

Objection	Response built into the initiative
“A 30-day pilot cannot prove student achievement.”	Correct. It measures activation, usability, time, participation, and alignment quality. Academic impact requires a longer comparison study and is not claimed here.
“Time saved is self-reported and biased.”	Capture the baseline before use, repeat the same question at exit, pair it with completion events, and report the limitation. Treat the result as directional, not causal.
“One outcome is too narrow to represent the platform.”	Narrowness is the point of the first proof: it controls scope and makes the integrated story observable. Expansion is earned after the first loop works.
“Framework support is easy for competitors to copy.”	The moat is not a label. Madlen must compound ready-made framework structure, lower setup, bilingual output, connected student evidence, and school-specific learning data.
“A free pilot may attract non-buyers.”	Require an executive sponsor, defined cohort, baseline, and final decision meeting before acceptance.
“Teachers may accept polished AI output without review.”	Track edit behaviour and serious correction rate; keep teacher approval at each stage and treat low review as a risk, not a success metric.

4. AI-powered mini-product prototype

Live product: Madlen Learning Loop - Candidate Prototype

Source: GitHub repository

The three tools are one application with shared navigation and visual language, but each remains independently usable.

PDF requirement	Implemented evidence
Lesson Prep: topic + grade, outline, objectives, key concepts	Structured, grade-aware lesson result.
Exactly five slides with title, bullets, visual suggestion	Strict JSON schema and Zod validation require exactly five.
2-3 discussion questions	Schema enforces the range.
Student Chatbot: conversational and grade-calibrated	Topic, grade, conversation context, age-aware prompt.
Hints rather than direct practice answers	Guided-practice mode reveals one of three progressive hints.
Essay Grader: 3-4 transparent criteria	Four fixed criteria: Argument, Clarity, Evidence, Structure.
Passage-specific feedback and shareable summary	Exact-substring quotation checks plus copy action.
End-to-end public, polished experience	Responsive Netlify deployment, loading/error/retry states, server-side API key.

The candidate prototype demonstrates the interaction concept; it deliberately does not claim live curriculum alignment because no curriculum retrieval source was supplied. That honesty prevents the prototype from being used as evidence for a production capability it does not contain.

5. Social media post - one Madlen core tool

Creative brief

- Platform: LinkedIn first; the 1080 x 1080 asset also works on Instagram.
- Audience: PYP teachers, PYP coordinators, and academic leaders.
- Tool: Madlen PYP Unit Planner.
- Main benefit: reduce planning administration while preserving the inquiry structure teachers care about.
- Evidence used: Madlen's public product flow asks for a transdisciplinary theme and central idea, then generates editable, bilingual lines of inquiry and questions.

On-image copy

PYP UNIT PLANNER

Plan the inquiry. Not the paperwork.

Turn a transdisciplinary theme and central idea into editable, bilingual lines of inquiry and guiding questions.

Theme + central idea → Editable bilingual unit plan

PYP-aligned · Bilingual output · Editable plan

See PYP planning in action →

Caption

PYP planning should protect time for inquiry, not consume it with repetitive setup.

Start with your transdisciplinary theme and central idea. Madlen's PYP Unit Planner helps turn them into editable, bilingual lines of inquiry and guiding questions - giving teachers a structured first draft while keeping professional judgement in control.

See PYP planning in action with Madlen.

#PYP #IBEducation #TeacherPlanning #AIinEducation #EdTech

Why this creative

The previous learning-loop concept communicated the strategy but did not satisfy the brief's “one core tool” requirement. PYP Unit Planner was selected because it is a real public Madlen tool and a concrete proof point for the curriculum-fit differentiation. The input-to-output line makes the product mechanism understandable at a glance, while the paper-planner illustration communicates inquiry without using a generic AI robot or developer dashboard. Exact copy and the official Madlen logo were added deterministically rather than generated by AI, preventing brand or spelling errors.

Counterargument - the tool is relevant to a narrower audience: true, but narrow relevance improves message clarity and lead quality. A broad “AI for every task” post would recreate the undifferentiated toolbox problem identified in the competitor analysis.

Final asset: **social/madlen-pyp-unit-planner-social-post-1080.png**

Final 1080 x 1080 social creative

Sources

Accessed 24 August 2026.

1 Madlen product page and PYP Unit Planner flow

2 Madlen English product positioning and named curricula

3 MagicSchool pricing and plan comparison

4 MagicSchool teacher platform and product experience

5 MagicSchool integrations

6 Anthropic customer story: MagicSchool adoption

7 Brisk plans

8 Brisk product architecture

9 Brisk school and district positioning

10 Brisk Educator Pro

11 Brisk adoption statement

12 Tech & Learning 2025 Best for Back to School winners